STAGES	The First Hour				Home Preparation				Transport & Transit		Crematorium/ burial	Post-Cremation (hindu)		The Mourning	
ACTIVITIES	Confirmation of Death	Legal Paperwork (MCCD)	Family Broadcast	Slot Booking	Body Preservation	Ritual Materials (Samagri)	Priest Coordination	Bathing/Dressing	Hearse Van Arrival	The Procession	Payment	Ash Collection (Asthi)	Ash Immersion (Visarjan)	Death Registration	family Meeting
Direct Vendor (DIY)	Call to family doctor / local clinic.	Physical visit to hospital desk or clinic.	Manual WhatsApp/ Phone calls.	Physical queue at the Municipal counter; showing ID proofs.	Finding “Sticker“ numbers on walls/gates for Freezer Box.	Family member runs to local market with a handwritten list.	Finding an available “Priest“ on the spot.	Done by family with no external guidance.	Haggling over “AC vs. Non-AC“ and “Flower decor“ at the gate.	Family manages traffic.	Multiple touchpoints: Wood-seller, Stretcher-bearers (Tips).,etc	Physical return to the Ghat after 2 days; messy collection.	Self-booked travel to Haridwar/Varanasi/local river.	Multiple visits to the Municipal (BBMP/ MCG/MCD) office.	Family rents a community hall and finds a vendors.
Middleman (Trust-Based)	Call to family elder or priest for “what to do.“	Middleman brings a “known“ doctor home.	Family handles personal calls.	Middleman uses local “influence“ to get a slot.	Middleman calls his regular “Freezer guy.“	Middleman brings a sack of basic items.	Your “Family Priest“ is already waiting there.	Priest/Elder guides the family on directions/steps.	Middleman ensures the van is parked correctly.	Middleman leads the procession flow.	Lumpsum “Dakshina“ given to Middleman to distribute./ To people involved while transportation	Middleman collects and keeps it in a “Locker.“	Middleman connects with a “Panda“ at the holy site.	No help provided; family struggles with bureaucracy.	Local community helps organize the get together
Funeral Startup (Professional)	Call to 24/7 Helpline or App Chat.	Startup coordinates a home-visit doctor.	Startup provides “Digital Obituary“ templates.	Pre-booked slot via digital coordination with the Ghat.	App-based booking for sanitized freezer box.	Standardized “Antim Sanskar Kit“ delivered.	Certified, multi-lingual priest assigned by Startup.	Professional “Body Embalmers/Caregivers“ assist.	GPS-tracked hearse with professional driver in uniform.	Staff handles the transition from home to van.	No-Tip Policy; all-inclusive payment made via App/UPI.	Startup collects, places in an Urn, and delivers to home.	End-to-end “Visarjan Package“ (Flight, Boat, Priest).	Startup handles the legal filing and delivers certificate home.	Startup books the Venue, Catering, and Live Streaming.

Path	**Direct Vendor**	**Middleman**	**Funeral Startup**
Expectation	I will save money by doing it myself.	The middleman will handle the culture and the ‘system’.	One call should solve everything with dignity.
Reality	High “decision fatigue.“ The family is forced to be logistics managers when they are emotionally depleted.	Very smooth but opaque. The family often feels they are being overcharged because they can’t see the “bill,“ but they accept it for the sake of peace.	High transparency and “corporate” empathy. Standardized kits mean no one has to run to the market for agarbatti or shrouds.
Gap	Lack of hygiene and extreme price volatility.	Dependence on one person’s availability; no accountability if things go wrong.	May feel “too mechanical” or “modern” for very traditional families who prefer the personal touch of a family priest.
Average Feeling	Unhappy	Overall Satisfied	Overall Satisfied
Experience	You are mourning but also checking if the wood is dry and the driver is overcharging.	You feel protected and traditional, but have a nagging feeling you paid a “Grief Tax.”	You feel like a “guest” at the funeral; high relief from logistics, but can feel slightly “corporate.”